Abstract

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Chapter 1

Introduction

Chapter 2

Some Basics of Finite Fields

Chapter 3

Exponential Sums over Finite Fields

Exponential sums are important tools in number thoery for solving problems involving integers. These sums have many applications in Analytic Number Theory.

In this chapter we will set up exponential sums for finite fields by special group homomorphisms called *characters*. Since a finite field has two different inherent group structure; one is additive and the other is multiplicative we obtain two different characters. Exponential sums are formed by using the values of one or more characters and possibly combining them with weights or with other function values.

3.1 Characters of Finite Abelian Groups

Let G be a finite abelian group with the identity element 1_G. Let S^1 be the set of complex numbers with absolute value 1. Then consider the multiplicative group S^1 with the operation of multiplication.

Definition 3.1.1: Character χ of G

A *character* χ of G is a group homomorphism $\chi : G \to S^1$ to the multiplicative group S^1 i.e. for all $g_1, g_2 \in G$

$$\chi(g_1 \cdot g_2) = \chi(g_1) \cdot \chi(g_2)$$

So if χ is any character of G then $\chi(1_G) = 1$. Since by definition for all $g \in G$,

$$\chi(g)^{|G|} = \chi(g^{|G|}) = \chi(1_G) = 1$$

the values of χ are $|G|^{th}$ roots of unity. Also we have for any $g \in G$,

$$\chi(g)\chi(g^{-1}) = \chi(g \cdot g^{-1}) = \chi(1_G) = 1$$

so $\chi(g^{-1}) = \chi(g)^{-1} = \overline{\chi(g)}$.

There are some special characters of G which have specific name. The character χ_0 defined by $\chi_0(g) = 1$ for all $g \in G$ is called the *trivial character*. For any character χ of G, the character $\overline{\chi}$ defined by $\overline{\chi}(g) = \overline{\chi(g)}$ for all $g \in G$ is called the *conjugate character* of χ.

Given any finitely many characters of G, $\chi_1, \ldots, \chi_n$ we can define the product character $\chi = \chi_1 \cdot \chi_2 \cdots \chi_n$ such that for all $g \in G$,

$$\chi(g) = \chi_1(g) \cdot \chi_2(g) \cdots \chi_n(g)$$

Hence for all $g \in G$,

$$\chi(g) \cdot \overline{\chi}(g) = |\chi(g)|^2 = 1$$

Hence the $\overline{\chi}$ is also the inverse character of χ. Hence the set of all characters of G forms a group, $\mathrm{Hom}(G, S^1)$ under multiplication whose identity element is the trivial character χ_0.

Definition 3.1.2: Dual Group to G

For a finite abelian group G, the group of all characters of G with the identity element χ_0 is called the *dual group* to G and is denoted by $\widehat{G}$ i.e. $\widehat{G} := \mathrm{Hom}(G, S^1)$.

Observation 3.1. *The dual group $\widehat{G}$ is abelian.*

Since the values of characters of G can only be $|G|^{th}$ roots of unity, the dual group $\widehat{G}$ is a finite abelian group.

Lemma 3.1.1

If G is a finite cyclic group of order n and let g be the generator of G, then for all $j \in \{0, 1, \ldots, n-1\}$ define the function

$$\chi_j(g^k) = e(jk/n) \quad \forall\, k \in \{0, 1, \ldots, n-1\}$$

Then $\widehat{G} = \{\chi_j : j \in \{0, 1, \ldots, n-1\}$.

Proof: Certainly for all $j \in \{0, 1, \ldots, n-1\}$ defines a character of G. On the other hand suppose, $\chi \in \widehat{G}$. Then $\chi(g)$ must be an nth root of unity. Hence there exists $j \in \{0, 1, \ldots, n-1\}$ such that $\chi(g) = e(j/n)$. Therefore $\chi = \chi_j$. Hence $\widehat{G} = \{\chi_j : 0 \le j \le n-1\}$. ■

Observation 3.2. *The characters defined in above lemma forms a cyclic group with χ_1 being the generator of $\widehat{G}$.*

Corollary 3.1.2

If G is a finite cyclic group of order n with g being the generator then $G \cong \widehat{G}$ by the isomorphism $\varphi : g^j \mapsto \chi_j$ for all $j \in \{0, 1, \ldots, n-1\}$.

Now we will show that we can extend a character of any subgroup to a character of the group.

Theorem 3.1.3

Let H be a subgroup of the finite abelian group G and let χ_H be a character of H. Then χ_H can be extended to a character of G that is there exists a character $\chi \in \widehat{G}$ with $\chi(h) = \chi_H(h)$ for all $h \in H$.

Proof: Let H be a proper subgroup of G. Let $\alpha \in G \setminus H$. Then let H_1 be the group generated by H and α i.e. $H_1 = \langle H, a \rangle$. Let m be the smallest positive integer such that $\alpha^m \in H$. Then for all $g \in H_1$, g can be written uniquely as $g = \alpha^j \cdot h$ where $0 \le j < m$ and $h \in H$.

Let ω be a complex number such that $\omega^m = \chi_H(\alpha^m)$. Then for all $g \in H_1$ where $g = \alpha^j \cdot h$, $h \in H$ define the function $\chi_1(g) = \omega^j \chi_H(h)$. Then for any $g_1, g_2 \in H_1$ where $g_1 = \alpha^i \cdot h_1$, $g_2 = \alpha^j \cdot h_2$, we have $g_1 \cdot g_2 = \alpha^{j+k} \cdot h_1 \cdot h_2 = \alpha^{j+k \bmod m} \cdot h_1 \cdot h_2$. Hence

$$\chi_1(g_1 \cdot \chi_2) = \omega^{j+k \bmod m} \chi_H(h_1) \cdot \chi_H(h_2) = \alpha^j \chi_H(h_1) \cdot \omega^k \chi_H(h_2) = \chi_1(g_1) \cdot \chi_1(g_2)$$

Hence χ_1 is a character of H_1. And also for all $h \in H$ we have $\chi_1(h) = \chi_H(h)$.

So if $H_1 = G$ we are done. Otherwise we can continue this process above until we get G. This process we have to do finitely many times as G is a finite group. ■

Therefore if we have two distinct elements $g_1, g_2 \in G$, $g_1 \neq g_2$ then take the subgroup generated by the element $h = g_1 \cdot g_2^{-1} \neq 1$. Since this subgroup is a cyclic subgroup generated by h, by Lemma 3.1.1 we get a character χ' of the cyclic subgroup such that $\chi'(h) \neq 1$. Then by Theorem 3.1.3 we get a character χ of G such that $\chi(h) = \chi'(h) \neq 1$ and hence $\chi(g_1) \neq \chi(g_2)$. Therefore we have the following observation

Observation 3.3. *For any two distinct elements $g_1, g_2 \in G$, $g_1 \neq g_2$ we can get a character $\chi \in \widehat{G}$ such that $\chi(g_1) \neq \chi(g_2)$.*

Now every element of $\widehat{G}$ is a function χ which takes an element of G and maps to a complex number in S^1. Similarly we can think of every element of as a function from $\widehat{G}$ to S^1. In fact for every element $g \in G$ define the homomorphism $\mathrm{ev}_g : \widehat{G} \to S^1$ where $\mathrm{ev}_g(\chi) = \chi(g)$. Hence ev_g is a character of $\widehat{G}$ for all $g \in G$.

Theorem 3.1.4

Let G be a finite abelian group.

(i) If $\chi \in \widehat{G}$ be any nontrivial character then

$$\sum_{g \in G} \chi(g) = 0 \tag{3.1}$$

(ii) If $g \in G$ with $g \neq 1_G$ then

$$\sum_{\chi \in \widehat{G}} \chi(g) = 0 \tag{3.2}$$

Proof: Since χ is nontrivial there exists $h \in G$ such that $\chi(h) \neq 1$. Then

$$\chi(h) \sum_{g \in G} \chi(g) = \sum_{g \in G} \chi(h \cdot g) = \sum_{g \in G} \chi(g)$$

Hence we have

$$(\chi(h) - 1) \sum_{g \in G} \chi(g) = 0$$

Since we know $\chi(h) \neq 1$ we have $\sum_{g \in G} \chi(g) = 0$.

Now from the discussion above for any $g \in G$ and $\chi \in hG$ we have $\chi(g) = \mathrm{ev}_g(\chi)$. Hence

$$\sum_{\chi \in \widehat{G}} \chi(g) = \sum_{\chi \in \widehat{G}} \mathrm{ev}_g(\chi)$$

Since $g \neq 1_G$, there is a $\chi \in \widehat{G}$ such that $\chi(g) \neq 1$. Hence ev_g is a nontrivial character of $\widehat{G}$. Hence by the first part of the theorem we have $\sum_{\chi \in \widehat{G}} \mathrm{ev}_g(\chi) = 0$. ■

The above theorem leaves the case when χ is the trivial character. Then for all $g \in G$, $\chi(g) = 1$. Hence we have $\sum_{g \in G} \chi(g) = |G|$. Hence we have the following corollary

Observation 3.4. *For any finite abelian group G. Then*

(i) Let χ is a character of G.

$$\sum_{g \in G} \chi(g) = \begin{cases} |G| & \text{if } \chi = \chi_0 \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases} \tag{3.3}$$

(ii) $|G| = \sum_{\chi \in \widehat{G}} \sum_{g \in G} \chi(g)$

So now by counting in two ways for the sum $\sum_{\chi \in \widehat{G}} \sum_{g \in G} \chi(g)$ we get the following theorem:

Theorem 3.1.5

For any finite abelian group G, we have $|G| = |\widehat{G}|$.

Proof:

■

3.2 Gauss Sums

3.3 Jacobi Sums

3.4 L-functions

Chapter 4

Equations over Finite Fields

Chapter 5

Stepanov and Bombieri's Method

Chapter 6

Pseudopolynomials

Chapter 7

Decoding from Quadratic Character Evaluations